Billing and Payments: User Guide

HMS · For reception, cashiers, doctors, pharmacists, lab staff, managers and owners · October 2026

In one line: the OPD, the lab and the pharmacy each make their own bill and take their own money. Medicines are never added to the doctor's bill, and tests are never added to the doctor's fee. Owners and managers see all the money in one place, **Billing › Finance**, where every rupee is counted once.

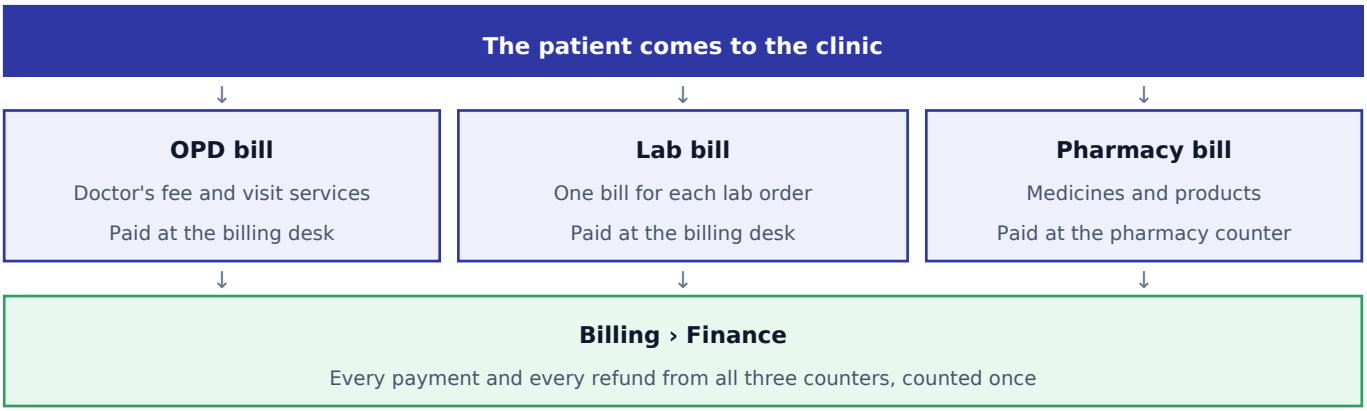
What is in this guide

#	Section	Read this if you are…
1	The three bills of a visit	Everyone
2	Who can do what (roles)	Owner, manager
3	Setting up billing for the first time	Owner, manager
4	OPD: from check-in to payment	Reception, cashier, doctor
5	Taking a payment	Reception, cashier
6	Refunds, cancelling and correcting a bill	Cashier, manager
7	Lab bills	Lab staff, cashier
8	The pharmacy counter: sales, balances and returns	Pharmacist
9	The Finance screen	Owner, manager, accountant
10	When something does not work	Everyone
11	Where to find things	Everyone

1. The three bills of a visit

One patient visit can create up to three separate bills. Each one is paid at its own counter. Because they are separate, nothing is ever charged twice.

FLOW CHART 1 · ONE VISIT, THREE BILLS, ONE FINANCE VIEW



Bill	What is on it	When it is made	Where it is paid
OPD	The doctor's consultation fee (or follow-up fee) and any "per visit" or "procedure" services	At check-in, after the consultation, or only when the desk makes it — you choose (section 3)	**Billing** → open the bill → **Take payment**
Lab	The tests on that order, at the price on the day of the order	When the tests are ordered, or when the lab signs off	**Billing** → open the bill → **Take payment**
Pharmacy	Medicines and other products	Always at the moment of sale	At the pharmacy counter itself

2. Who can do what

What a person can do depends on their **role**. The owner sets roles in **Roles & Permissions**.

Job	Permission to switch on	Group	Usually given to
Check a patient in and call them	Check in patients and call them through	Appointments	Receptionist (doctors too, in small clinics)
Start and finish a consultation	Start a consultation / Complete and reopen a consultation	Appointments	Doctor
See bills	View invoices and payments	Billing & Payments	Receptionist, cashier, accountant, manager
Take a payment	Record a payment	Billing & Payments	Receptionist, cashier, accountant, manager
Make a bill by hand	Create invoices	Billing & Payments	Accountant, manager
Correct an unpaid bill	Edit an invoice before payment	Billing & Payments	Accountant, manager
Cancel a bill	Cancel an invoice	Billing & Payments	Manager
Give money back	Refund a payment	Billing & Payments	Accountant, manager
See all departments' money	View finance across OPD, lab and pharmacy	Billing & Payments	Accountant, manager, head office
Sell at the pharmacy	Sell at the counter	Pharmacy	Pharmacist
Take back medicines, cancel a pharmacy bill	Cancel a bill or take goods back	Pharmacy	Senior pharmacist, manager

How to change a role

1. Open **Roles & Permissions** from the sidebar.
2. Click the role on the left, for example **Receptionist**.
3. Open the **Permissions** tab and click a group, for example **Billing & Payments**.
4. Switch each permission on or off.
5. Click **Save Changes**.

The **Editing** box above the tabs says where the change applies. Leave it on **The whole organisation** to change every branch. Pick one branch to switch a permission off at that branch only. A branch can only take a permission away; it can never add one.

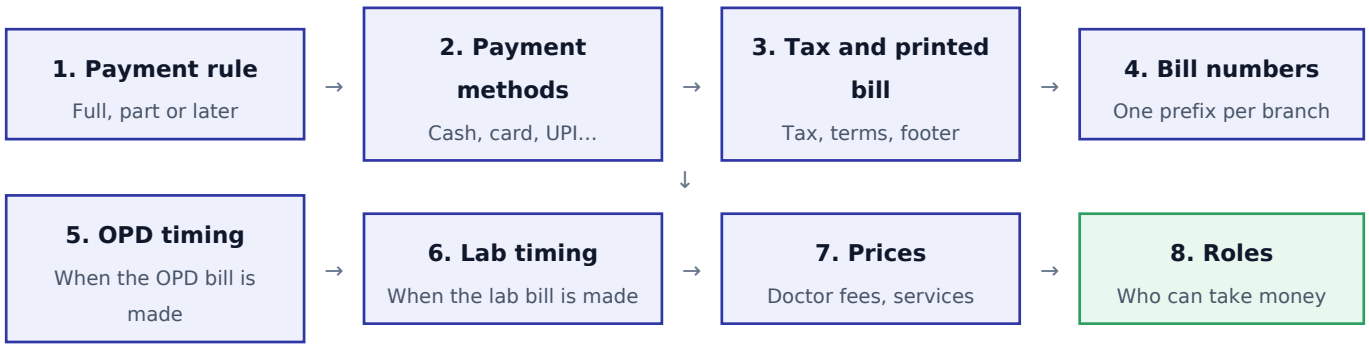
Check your receptionist. If your clinic bills at check-in, the receptionist must also have **View invoices and payments** and **Record a payment**. Otherwise the bill is made but nobody at the desk can take the money. Organisations set up before October 2026 should check this once.

The owner can do almost everything, but **cannot check patients in**. That is the desk's job, so the owner needs a staff login for it.

3. Setting up billing for the first time

Do these steps once, in this order. Most of them are in **Settings › Billing**.

FLOW CHART 2 · FIRST-TIME SETUP



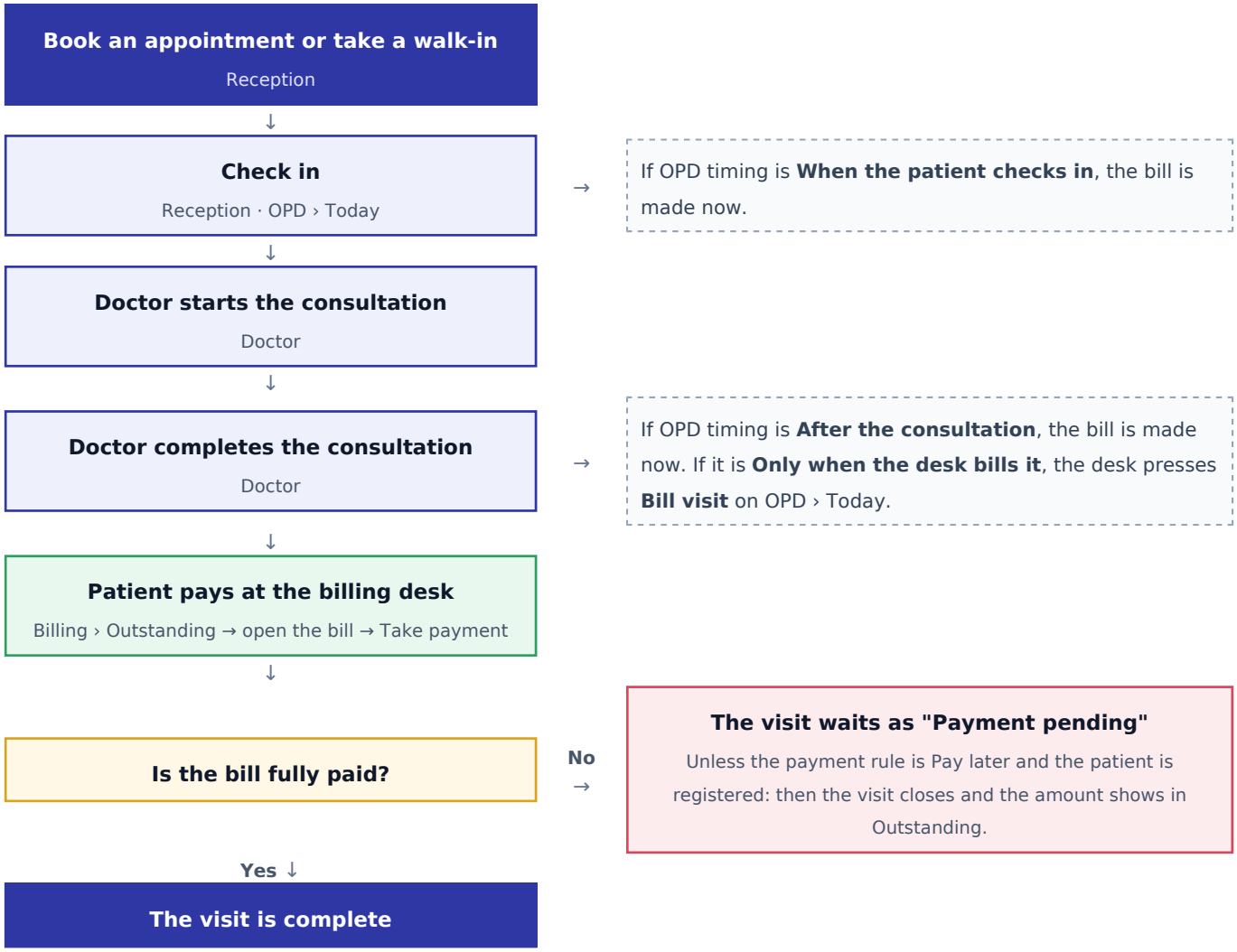
Step	Where	What to choose
1. Payment rule	Settings › Billing › Payments	**Pay in full**, **Part payment allowed** or **Pay later (credit)**. See section 5.
2. Payment methods	Settings › Billing › Payments	Tick every method you accept. The pharmacy uses the same list. "Credit" is not a method; it is the payment rule above.

Step	Where	What to choose
3. Tax and printed bill	Settings › Billing › Tax, Printed bill	Whether prices already include tax, the default tax rate, and the terms and footer printed on every bill. A change affects new bills only.
4. Bill numbers	Settings › Billing › Per branch	Each branch numbers its own bills, receipts, refunds, pharmacy bills and pharmacy returns, for example `GGN/INV/26-27/00001`. Numbers restart every 1 April. Bills already issued keep their numbers.
5. OPD timing	Settings › Billing › Billing by department › OPD	**When the patient checks in** (fee taken first), **After the consultation** (most common), or **Only when the desk bills it**.
6. Lab timing	Settings › Billing › Billing by department › Laboratory	**When the tests are ordered**, **After the lab signs off**, or **Only when the lab counter bills it**.
7. Prices	Doctors (each doctor's profile) and Billing › Services & prices	Set each doctor's consultation fee. Add services such as a registration charge, a follow-up fee or a dressing. A branch can have its own price for a service.
8. Roles	Roles & Permissions	Make sure the people at the billing desk can view bills and record payments (section 2).

Pharmacy settings (price basis, tax, walk-in sales, credit sales, prescription check) are in **Pharmacy › Settings**. The Pharmacy card on the Billing settings page shows a summary and a link.

4. OPD: from check-in to payment

FLOW CHART 3 · THE OPD VISIT AND ITS BILL



What goes on the OPD bill

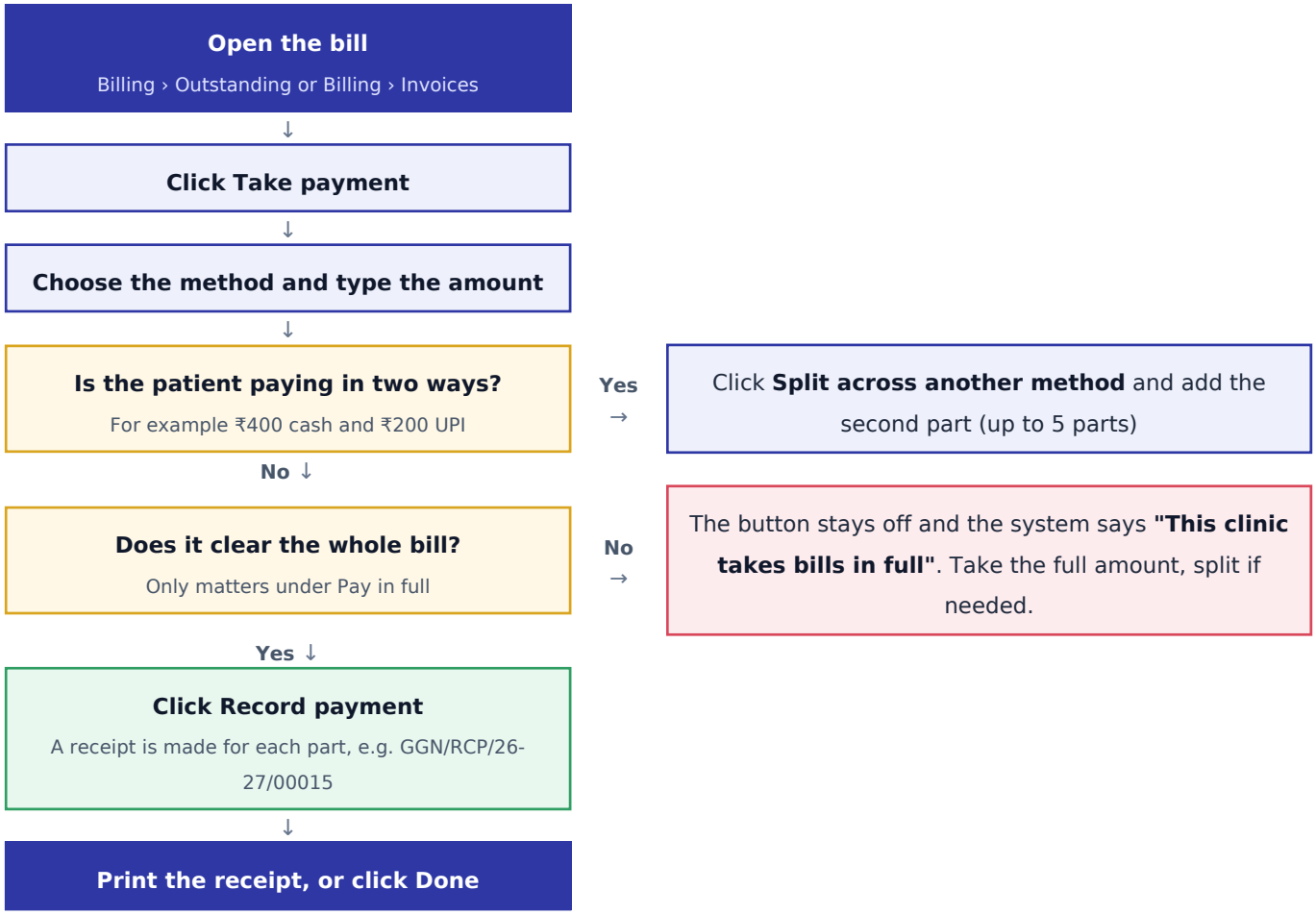
- **The doctor's fee** — the "default consultation fee" on the doctor's profile.
- **A follow-up fee instead** — if the patient comes back to the same doctor within the follow-up days the doctor wrote last time, and you have a "Follow-up fee" service. Set its price to 0 to make follow-ups free.
- **"Per visit" and "Procedure" services** — added to every visit automatically. If a branch has its own price for a service, only the branch price is used.

Example. Dr. Mehta's fee is ₹500 and the clinic has a ₹100 "Registration" per-visit service. Every new visit to Dr. Mehta makes one bill of ₹600: `GGN/INV/26-27/00042`.

One visit has only one OPD bill. Checking in again, reopening the consultation or pressing Bill visit twice brings back the same bill. It never makes a second one.

5. Taking a payment

FLOW CHART 4 · TAKING A PAYMENT AT THE BILLING DESK



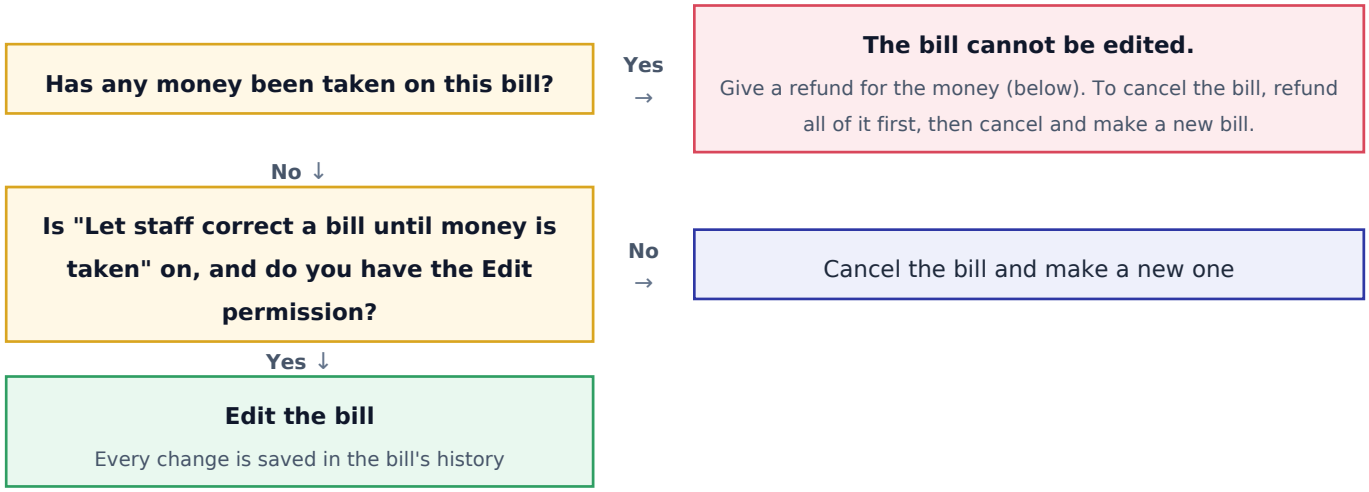
The three payment rules

Rule	What happens at the desk	Good for
Pay in full (default)	The whole amount must be paid in one go. The patient can still pay with two methods at once using **Split across another method**.	Most clinics
Part payment allowed	The patient can pay some now and the rest later. The visit shows "Payment pending" until it is cleared.	Clinics that take instalments
Pay later (credit)	A registered patient can leave without paying. The visit closes and the amount waits in **Billing › Outstanding**. Walk-in patients cannot use credit.	Regular patients with an account

Clicking twice is safe. Each payment window has its own hidden ID. If the button is clicked twice, or the internet drops and the request is sent again, the second click returns the first payment. Money is never recorded twice.

6. Refunds, cancelling and correcting a bill

FLOW CHART 5 · A BILL IS WRONG — WHAT CAN I DO?



How to give a refund

1. Open the bill.
2. In the **Payments** list, click **Refund** next to the payment you are giving back.
3. Type the amount and the reason, then click **Refund**.
4. A refund slip is made, for example `GGN/RFD/26-27/00003`. Print it from the same list.

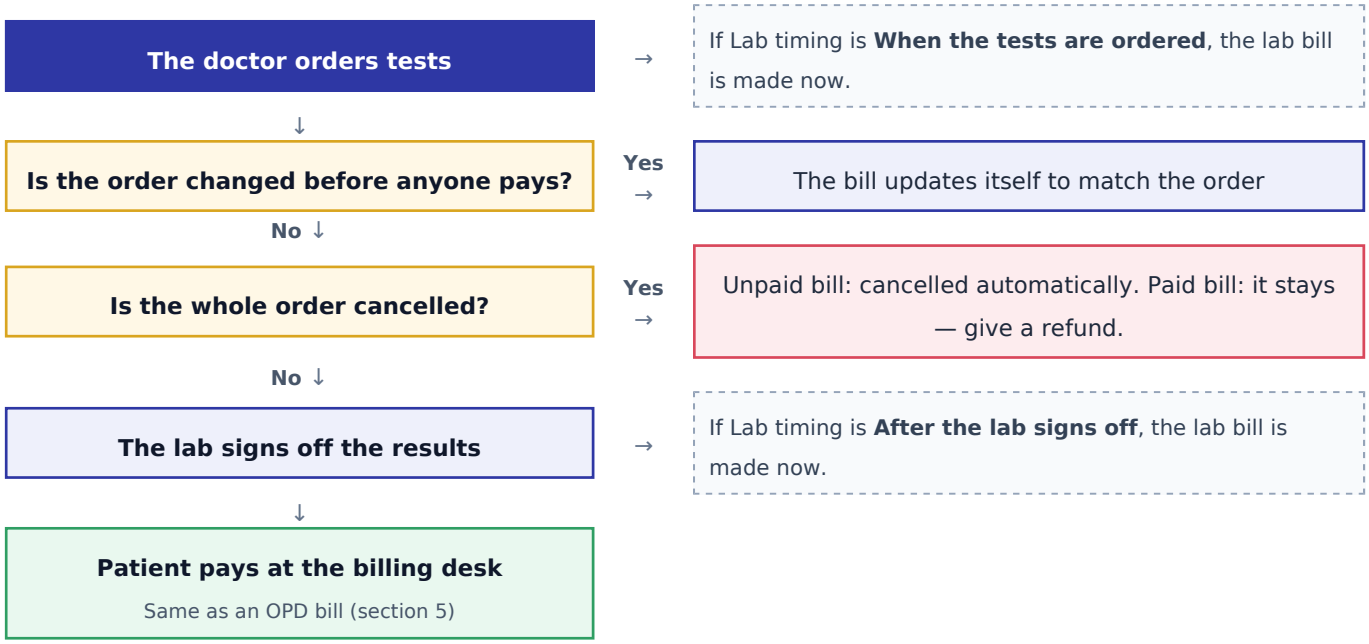
A refund lowers the bill. The patient is not asked for that money again.

Example	Status after	Still owed
₹600 bill, ₹600 paid, ₹100 refunded as a discount	Part refunded	₹0
₹600 bill, ₹600 paid, ₹600 refunded	Refunded	₹0

Nothing is ever deleted. A cancelled bill, a refund or a correction stays on the record with who did it and when.

7. Lab bills

FLOW CHART 6 · A LAB ORDER AND ITS BILL



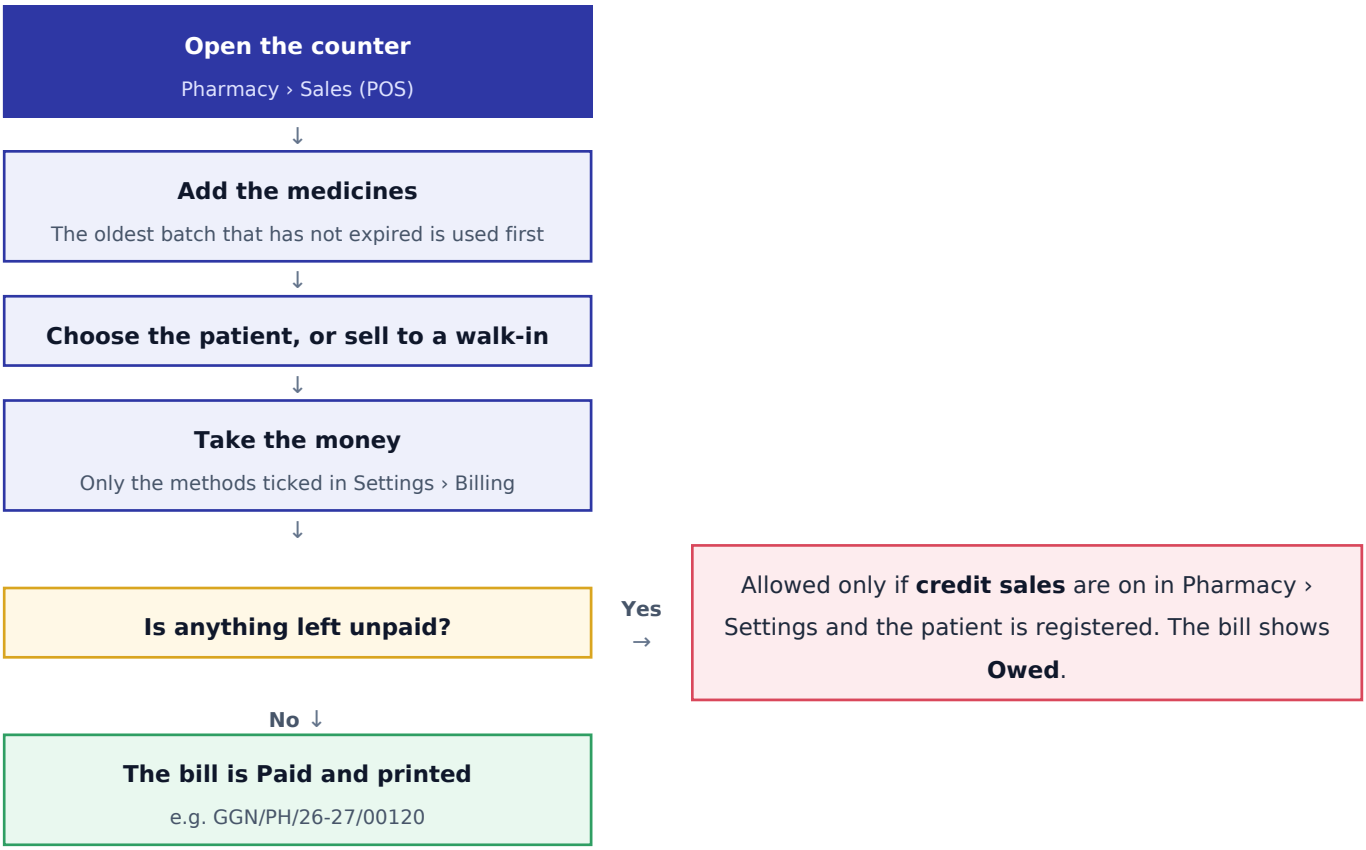
- Each lab order has its own bill. It shows as **Laboratory** in **Billing › Invoices**.
- The price is the price on the day of the order.
- If the lab module is switched off later, old lab bills still show in Billing and Finance.

The lab's own screens are still being built. Until they are ready, choose **When the tests are ordered** or **After the lab signs off**, so lab bills are made automatically.

8. The pharmacy counter

The pharmacy takes its own money. A patient never goes to the billing desk to pay for medicines.

FLOW CHART 7 · A PHARMACY SALE



Opening a pharmacy bill

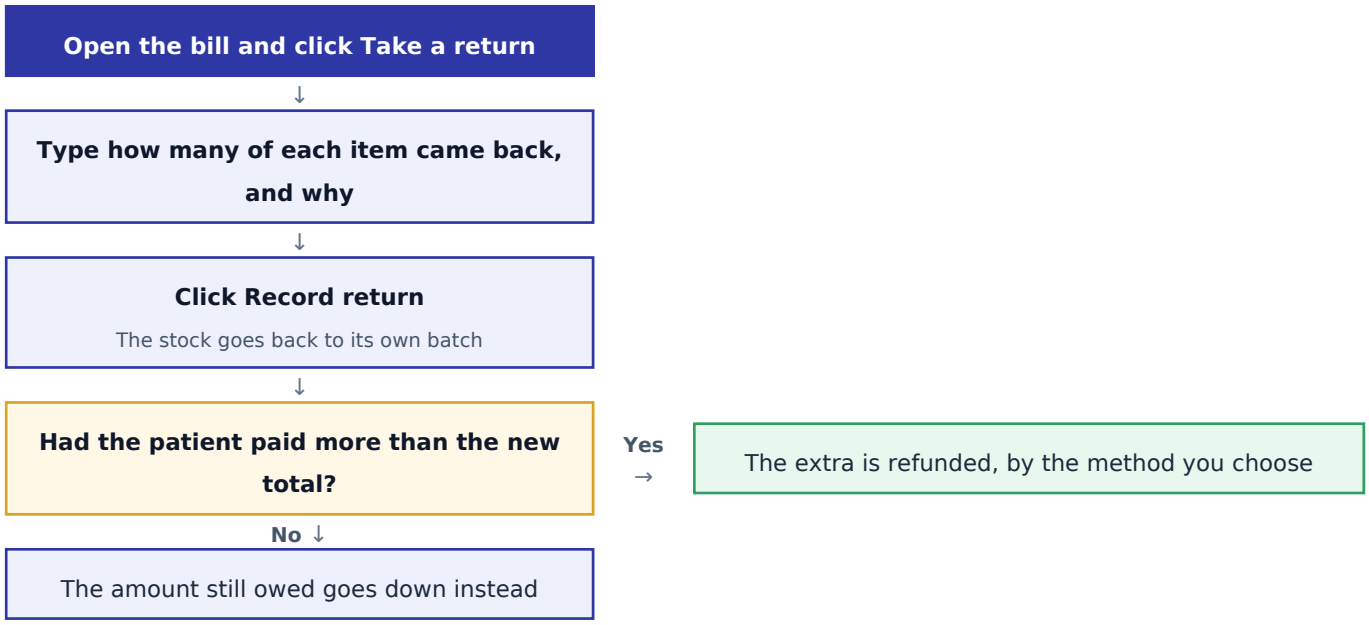
Go to **Pharmacy › Bills**, search by bill number, name or phone, and click **View**. The bill shows:

- **The patient** — name, patient ID, age, gender, phone, town, and **Open patient file**. A walk-in shows a "Walk-in" tag.
- **The bill** — date and time, store, who billed it, the doctor (if it came from a prescription), and the payment status.
- **The items** — with "10 back" under any quantity that was returned.
- **Money in and out** — every payment, refund and return, next to the totals. "Owed" is red; "Settled" is green.

Collecting a balance later

1. Open the bill in **Pharmacy › Bills**.
2. Click **Take payment · ₹…** at the bottom.
3. Choose the method, check the amount, and click **Take payment**.

FLOW CHART 8 · TAKING MEDICINES BACK



Example. A patient paid ₹84 by card for 30 Dolo 650 tablets and one ORS packet. They bring back 10 tablets. The return is worth ₹20.70, so ₹20.70 goes back to the card. The return gets its own number, `GGN/PHR/26-27/00001`, and the bill shows "10 back".

Cancel this bill puts every item back on the shelf and records any money taken as a refund. The bill stays on the record, marked Cancelled.

9. The Finance screen

Billing › Finance shows the money of the OPD, the lab and the pharmacy together. Pick the dates at the top right. A branch manager sees their own branch; head office sees every branch.

Figure	What it means
Billed	The total of the bills raised in the dates you picked. Cancelled bills are not counted.
Collected	The money actually received in those dates, from payments only.
Refunded	The money given back in those dates.
Net collections	Collected minus refunded — what really stayed with you.
Outstanding	What patients owe **today**, whenever the bill was made.

Below the figures you see the same numbers **by department**, **by payment method**, **by branch** and **day by day**, and one list of every bill from all three departments. Switch on **Only bills still owed** to see who has to pay.

Example. In October the OPD billed ₹1,750 that is still unpaid and the pharmacy has ₹13,575 on credit. Outstanding shows **₹15,325**, and the department table shows the two parts separately.

10. When something does not work

What you see	Why, and what to do
"This clinic takes bills in full"	The payment rule is Pay in full. Take the whole amount (split it across methods if needed), or ask the owner to choose Part payment allowed.
No **Take payment** button	Your role does not have **Record a payment**, or the bill is already paid or cancelled. Ask the owner to check your role (section 2).
No bill after check-in	Check the OPD timing in Settings › Billing. Check that the doctor has a consultation fee. Check that billing is switched on for that branch.
The visit stays "Payment pending"	A bill for this visit still owes money: the OPD bill, a lab bill or a pharmacy bill. Clear it, or use the Pay later rule for registered patients.
"has had money taken against it, so it cannot be edited"	A paid bill is never changed. Refund the payment, or refund all of it and cancel the bill, then make a new one.
"This clinic does not take …"	That payment method is not ticked in Settings › Billing › Payments.
No **Finance** in the menu	Your role needs **View finance across OPD, lab and pharmacy**.
A pharmacy sale will not save with money left unpaid	Credit sales are off in Pharmacy › Settings, or the buyer is a walk-in. Take the full amount or choose a registered patient.
I clicked Record payment twice	Nothing to do. The second click returned the first payment; there is only one receipt.

11. Where to find things

I want to…	Go to
See who still has to pay	**Billing › Outstanding**
Find any OPD or lab bill	**Billing › Invoices**
See every payment taken	**Billing › Payments**
See all departments' money	**Billing › Finance**
Change prices and services	**Billing › Services & prices**
Change payment rules, tax, numbers, timings	**Settings › Billing**
Bill a finished visit by hand	**OPD › Today → Bill visit** (only when OPD timing is "Only when the desk bills it")
Sell medicines	**Pharmacy › Sales (POS)**

I want to…	Go to
Open a pharmacy bill, collect a balance, take a return	**Pharmacy › Bills → View**
Change pharmacy rules (credit, walk-in, prices)	**Pharmacy › Settings**
Give or take away permissions	**Roles & Permissions**
Read this guide again	**Help › Guide**